



A FIELD GUIDE FOR LEADERS

Why a Great Video Is a *Waste* of Money

On the difference between paying for polished creative — and paying to solve the problem the creative was quietly asked to fix.

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01

THE REAL
PROBLEM
SECTION ONE

WHERE THE MONEY ACTUALLY GOES

You don't have a creative problem.

Most teams don't waste money because they hired the wrong creative. They waste money because the brief was trying to solve a symptom. Someone says they need a video, a campaign, a rebrand, or a better website — but what they actually have is a positioning problem, a trust problem, audience confusion, weak internal alignment, or a broken handoff between leadership, marketing, and sales.

After enough rounds of this, smart leaders start to wonder whether marketing is worth paying for at all. Usually creative isn't the thing that failed — *it was asked to carry a problem it was never designed to solve.*

WHAT IS USUALLY UNDERNEATH THE ASK

- i A lack of clarity about what actually matters
- ii A message that still feels muddy to a stranger
- iii A weak understanding of the audience
- iv Beautiful work built on a confused foundation

If you're the one holding vision and execution together, this gets expensive fast — the pressure of making the right call, translating between teams, and trying not to waste budget again. This guide is for people who want to think clearly **before** they make something beautiful.



02

WHERE IT
BREAKS
FOUR FAILURE
POINTS

THE ANATOMY OF A WASTED BUDGET

Four ways good money goes to *waste*.

01

FAILURE POINT

Solving the wrong problem

A video is a delivery vehicle, not a diagnosis. If the real issue is weak positioning, audience confusion, or internal misalignment, even strong creative will miss. It may look better — but it's still aimed at the wrong thing.

What it sounds like — “We need a video.”

THE MOVE

Define the **decision you need to influence**, the confusion you need to remove, and the exact problem the asset must solve — before you talk about production.

02

FAILURE POINT

Your message is still muddy

If a stranger can't quickly grasp what you do, who it's for, and why it matters, the creative has to carry too much weight. Beautiful confusion is still confusion. Expensive confusion is worse.

THE MOVE

Get painfully clear about the **core problem you solve** and the language your audience already uses to describe it. Then make the creative serve that clarity.



02

WHERE IT
BREAKS
CONTINUED

03

FAILURE POINT

Polished, but not memorable

A lot of creative is technically good and strategically forgettable — tasteful, well shot, emotionally pleasant, and yet nobody can repeat the core idea afterward. Nothing lodges. Nothing travels.

THE MOVE

Decide what people should **still remember** one hour later, one day later, one week later. Then shape the asset around that idea — not around general atmosphere.

04

FAILURE POINT

There's no system after the asset

Even a strong video can't carry a broken funnel. If the landing page is vague, the CTA is weak, the follow-up is missing, or nobody owns the next step, the asset becomes a very pretty dead end.

THE MOVE

Build the handoff **before you launch**. Clarify the page, the CTA, the follow-up, and who is responsible for turning attention into action.

Creative is often where the pain shows up — *not where it starts.*



03

BEFORE YOU
SPEND MORE
THE DIAGNOSTIC

This isn't an argument against creative. It's an argument against using creative as *a substitute for diagnosis*.

ASK THESE SEVEN QUESTIONS FIRST

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1 What problem are we actually trying to solve? | 2 What would success look like, in plain language? |
| 3 What would still confuse a stranger right now? | 4 What must people remember after they watch? |
| 5 What happens right after they watch, land, or click? | 6 Where are we most likely to waste money if we're wrong? |
| 7 Are we solving the real issue — or just making the symptom prettier? | |



WHAT I ACTUALLY HELP WITH

Clarify the real problem

Get underneath the ask to the positioning, trust, or alignment issue the asset was quietly being built to fix — before a dollar goes to production.

Sharpen the message

Nail what you do, who it's for, and why it matters, in the language your audience already uses — so the creative has less to carry.

Something worth *talking through?*

No pitch. No package pushed at you. Just a conversation about what you're trying to do — and whether I'm the right person to help with it.

START THE DIAGNOSTIC
SCHEDULE A CALL
— ALL OF IT FREE —

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